



Pay anyone, anywhere, through any rail — with a link.

Non-custodial · multi-rail · blockchain-settled payments for East Africa.

THE PROBLEM

Accepting digital payments in Africa is custodial, single-rail, and hostile to small payments.



Custodial by default

Holding customer funds means a PSP / e-money licence, locked-up capital, and Central Bank approval before you can take a single shilling.



Single-rail, every time

M-Pesa *or* a card *or* a bank transfer — never one link a customer can simply open and pay, on whatever rail they already use.



Micropayment-hostile

Fixed processing fees make a tip, a song, or a single article simply not worth collecting — so a whole economy never gets built.

1–3%

Card interchange & processing fees — the wrong cost model for a KES 20 payment, before you even add a fixed per-transaction floor.

THE SOLUTION

A PayLink. Scan or click to pay — money goes straight to the receiver.

LinkMint never touches the funds. We verify a cryptographic **proof of payment** and finalise settlement on our own blockchain — the IVM.

① The PayLink

A shareable payment authorisation — a URL, a QR code, or an NFT. No payer account. No app to download.

② Non-custodial protocol

Funds flow rail → receiver directly. Because we never hold money, we sidestep PSP / e-money licensing entirely.

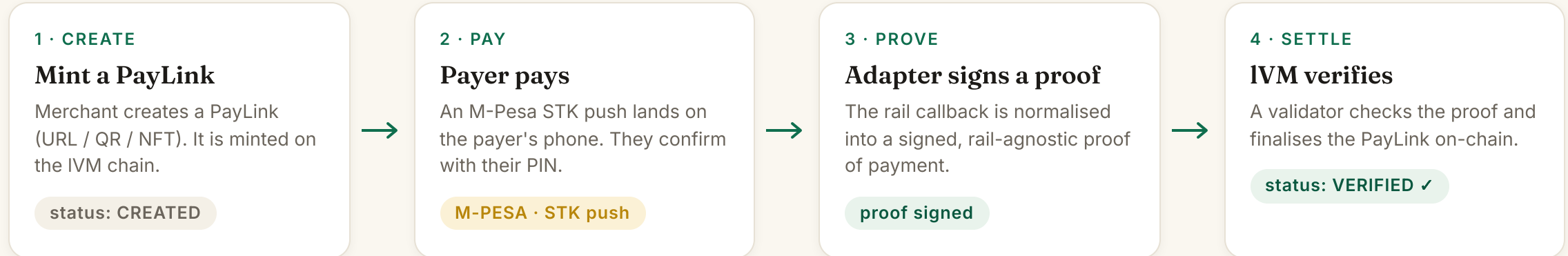
③ Programmable logic

One-time or multi-use, expiry, escrow conditions, and split payments — all enforced on-chain.

✓ **The money never touches LinkMint — we only move proofs, not funds.**

HOW IT WORKS

Create → Pay → Settle



```
proof_hash = SHA256( pl_id · receipt · amount ) → verified once, replay rejected
```

LinkMint verifies cryptographic proofs — it never holds the money.

Create → Pay → Settle, in about ten seconds — on our own chain.

1 Create a PayLink

Set receiver, amount and expiry. It's minted on the IVM chain — funds never touch the app.

2 Pay via M-PESA

An STK push to Pay Bill 174379. The payer confirms in their own M-Pesa app — no account, no install.

3 Settled on-chain

The signed proof is verified by a validator and the PayLink turns VERIFIED — in seconds.

```
$ make -C adapters/mpesa e2e
CREATED → VERIFIED · proof used ✓ · PASS (2.4s)
```

🕒 ACTUAL SCREEN · CAPTURED LIVE

localhost:3000 — LinkMint

Settlement • VERIFIED

Watching the PayLink settle on-chain (polling).

PayLink 0x2e62dc96fec132b92bd8df58bada88d69398
64d5a9033a06251da48eb4bea9d4

Votes 1

Chain tx 0x741c14387952d03bfacf47e4405ec082637
5ad9fddc6a782b1c0599b61b85ae8

Verified at 2026-06-02T22:03:45.832534Z

✅ Settled on-chain.

A real PayLink 0x2e62...a9d4, **VERIFIED on-chain** with a verifiable tx hash 0x741c...b85ae8 — not a mock-up.

The whole system runs end-to-end, today.

12

production-shaped microservices

1

custom blockchain — the IVM (Go · NIST P-256)

PASS

end-to-end M-Pesa settlement test, green in CI

80%

enforced test-coverage gate

SHIPPED & RUNNING

paylink-service

payment-orchestrator

proof-validator

identity

merchant-onboarding

compliance-risk

admin-backoffice

audit-log

notifications

invoicing

Kong gateway

IVM chain

M-Pesa adapter

JS SDK

Next.js web app

PRODUCTION-GRADE BY CONSTRUCTION

Idempotency keys

Event sourcing (Kafka/Redpanda)

Tamper-evident audit hash-chain

Append-only double-entry ledger

MFA

AES-GCM encryption at rest

OpenTelemetry tracing

Architecture Decision Records

ARCHITECTURE

Layered, rail-agnostic, blockchain-settled.

CLIENTS

Next.js web app

@linkmint/sdk (TypeScript)

QR · link · NFT

EDGE

API Gateway · Kong

JWT & API-key auth

rate-limit

signed X-Creator-Addr

CORE SERVICES

paylink

payment-orchestrator

proof-validator

identity

merchant-onboarding

compliance-risk

admin

audit-log

notifications

invoicing

RAIL ADAPTERS

M-Pesa · live

Card · next

Bank · next

Crypto (USDC) · next

SETTLEMENT LAYER

IVM blockchain · Go

NIST P-256 ECDSA

single-validator devnet

BFT / multi-validator ready

SHARED BACKBONE

Event bus

Double-entry ledger

Idempotency store

Telemetry (OTel)

Identical Go + Python client libraries — every service speaks the same wire.

MARKET

Start where mobile money already won — then expand the rails.



\$800B+ / yr

moves through mobile money across Sub-Saharan Africa — the rails our protocol plugs straight into. (GSMA, State of the Industry)

WHO PAYS & GETS PAID

SMB merchants

Payers — guest, no account

Developers / ISVs

Platforms & marketplaces

WHERE ONE LINK UNLOCKS NEW REVENUE

Micropayments & tips

Content unlocks

Invoices & subscriptions

Escrow & marketplaces

BUSINESS MODEL

A take-rate built for volume — and viable for the smallest payment.

0.5% ~~1-3%~~

our fee per settlement · min KES 1

card interchange

How the protocol fee is split



Fees reward the validators who secure the network and fund a deflationary burn. The PLN utility token aligns network security with real usage — no token speculation required to use LinkMint.

KES 1,000 sale → KES 5 fee

A normal merchant payment.

KES 50 tip → KES 1 fee

Micropayments finally make sense.

WHY LINKMINT WINS

One link does what no incumbent does at once.

	LinkMint	Traditional PSP	Card processor	Crypto wallet
Non-custodial — no PSP licence	✓	✗	✗	✓
Multi-rail in a single link	✓	partial	✗	✗
Micropayments viable	✓	✗	✗	gas-limited
No payer account / app needed	✓	✗	partial	✗
Programmable (escrow, splits, expiry)	✓	✗	✗	✓
Compliance built in (KYC / AML)	✓	✓	✓	✗
Fee on a KES 1,000 payment	0.5%	2–3%	1–3%	+ network gas

More revenue for merchants, real returns for investors, lift for the economy.

Merchants earn more

- **2–6× cheaper** than cards — 0.5% vs 1–3% keeps more of every shilling.
- **One link, every rail** → fewer abandoned checkouts, more completed sales.
- **New revenue lines:** tips, content unlocks, pay-per-use — viable only at micro-fees.

Easier to do business

- **Go live with a link** — no PSP licence, no capital lock-up, no bank integration.
- **Guest checkout:** customers pay with no account or app → higher conversion.
- **Escrow & splits** automate payouts for marketplaces and gig platforms.

A market ripe to disrupt → investor ROI

- Displaces the **custodial PSP + card-interchange** stack with a low-fee protocol.
- Take-rate on the **\$800B+/yr** SSA mobile-money flow → compounding, volume-based revenue.
- **Capital-light** — no float, no licence capital — so margins and scale follow usage.

Scaling & social impact

- Brings **SMEs & informal traders** formal, low-cost digital payments — financial inclusion.
- **Auditable history** unlocks credit access; lower fees keep money in local economies.
- **Borderless rails** (USDC next) → cross-border trade & diaspora remittances.

VERTICAL EXPANSION

Where LinkMint goes next: one protocol, many verticals.

The same PayLink primitive — a link, a micro-fee, programmable and non-custodial — unlocks vertical after vertical across East Africa.

Community & group money

LIVE · M-PESA

Chamas

SACCOs

Harambee

Churches & NGOs

Micro & metered commerce

LIVE · M-PESA

Creator tips

PAYGo solar & water

Transport fares

Ticketing (NFT)

Recurring & institutional

LIVE · M-PESA

School fees

Subscriptions

Micro-insurance

Gov / e-citizen fees

Trust-based trade

PHASE 2 · ESCROW

Social-commerce escrow

Marketplaces

Agri co-ops

B2B supply

Instant payouts & gig

PHASE 2 · PAYOUTS

Boda & delivery riders

Freelancers

Refunds

Claims & stipends

Cross-border & platform

PHASE 3 · DEV-LED

Diaspora remittances

Embedded "PaaS" via SDK

Alt. credit scoring

Non-custodial by design — compliant by construction.



Sidesteps PSP / e-money licensing

Because LinkMint never holds funds, it falls outside the Central Bank's custodial-licence regime.



KYC tiers & deterministic risk engine

Tiers 0 / 1 / 2 with a Tier-1 ceiling of KES 50,000. Every check returns allow / review / block — same inputs, same decision, every time.



Audit & integrity

Tamper-evident audit hash-chain · append-only double-entry ledger · AES-GCM at rest · multi-factor auth.

KENYA AML THRESHOLD

KES 150K

Cumulative-value transactions above the threshold are automatically held for enhanced review — built into the protocol, not bolted on.

Phase 1 is done. Now we scale rails and consensus.

Developer-led adoption (SDK + docs), SMB pilots in Eldoret & Nairobi, and a micropayment wedge — tips and content unlocks — that incumbents can't serve.

PHASE 1 · Q2 2026

✓ DONE

Working MVP

- IVM devnet + proof settlement
- M-Pesa rail, live
- 12 core services + JS SDK
- Web app + passing e2e

PHASE 2 · Q3 2026

NEXT

Scale & payouts

- Card + crypto (USDC) rails
- Multi-validator BFT consensus
- Merchant payouts (settlement)
- On-chain escrow

PHASE 3 · Q4 2026 +

SCALE

Mainnet & ecosystem

- Mainnet launch
- Full multi-language SDK suite
- Production KYC vendor
- Merchant & developer dashboards

TEAM

Founder-led — hiring to scale.



Victor Mbugua Kamande

FOUNDER & CEO · PROTOCOL ENGINEER

Designed and built the entire LinkMint stack end-to-end — the IVM blockchain, twelve backend services, the JavaScript SDK, and the web app — with a passing end-to-end M-Pesa settlement test in CI. [Add 1–2 lines on your background, prior work, and why you're the right person to build payments for East Africa.]

OPEN ROLES WE'RE HIRING WITH THIS ROUND

ENGINEERING

Protocol Engineer (Go · IVM)

ENGINEERING

Backend Engineer (services)

RISK

Compliance & Risk Lead

COMMERCIAL

Growth & Partnerships

Advisory — actively seeking mentors from the Rupa Mall innovator network across payments, fintech regulation, and go-to-market.

THE ASK

Let's bring programmable payments to East Africa.

WHAT WE'RE SEEKING AT THE SHOWCASE



Seed / grant capital

Funding to build Phase 2 and extend runway.



Pilot partners

Merchants & corporates to run live M-Pesa pilots.



Mentorship & advisory

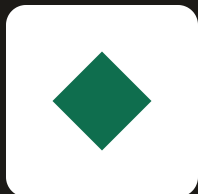
Technical and regulatory guidance to scale safely.



Commercialisation

Prize & partner support to reach market.

Use of funds: multi-rail + multi-validator BFT · first merchant pilots · compliance & legal.



Get in touch

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